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US equities tumble as tech leads decline, VIX spikes

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 fell -1.21% to 7,663.43, dragging the Nasdaq 100 down -2.90% to 28,958.69. Defensive sectors rallied, with the consumer staples ETF **XLP** up +3.31% and utilities **XLU** up +2.07%.

Volatility surged, VIX jumping +14.09% to 19.03. The 10-year Treasury yield slipped to 4.95%, while oil rose above 100 USD. Investors brace for a packed earnings week.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,663.43	-1.21%	
Dow Jones	52,867.98	+0.02%	
Nasdaq 100	28,958.69	-2.90%	
Russell 2000	2,784.03	+0.11%	
VIX	19.03	+14.09%	Volatility spike
10Y Yield	4.95%	-3.75%	
WTI Crude	100.44	+0.98%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
META	648.85	-6.98%
NVDA	212.21	-4.40%
AMZN	250.38	-4.57%
AVGO	323.24	-4.31%
MSFT	521.08	-2.23%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	NVDA
Q3 Revenue	31.2 bn
YoY Growth	-4.4%
Guidance	Revenue forecast cut 6% YoY

NVDA reported a 4.4% revenue decline and trimmed its FY guidance, underscoring weakening demand for AI chips. The miss amplified the tech sell-off and lifted the VIX.

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 4.95%, down 3.75 bps
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 03:30, Existing-home sales 04:45

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated; oil price above 100 USD.
- China’s manufacturing PMI slipped to 48.2, adding to global growth concerns.
- Eurozone core inflation held at 2.9%, limiting ECB rate-cut expectations.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
02:00	`AAPL`	iPhone demand, services margin
03:15	`GOOGL`	Ad revenue rebound, AI cloud spend
04:00	`JPM`	Net interest income, loan growth
04:30	`TSLA`	Model Y deliveries, margin trends

Stocks worth watching

- `XLF` – Financials up +1.09%, benefit from stable rates.
- `XLP` – Consumer staples rally; defensive play amid equity weakness.
- `NVDA` – Volatility driver; price may test 210 support.
- `META` – Deep discount; potential rebound if ad spend stabilises.
- `XLE` – Energy exposure as oil hovers above 100.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Further NVDA earnings miss or guidance cut.
- Escalation in Middle-East conflict pushing oil above 110 USD.
- Unexpected rise in CPI, prompting hawkish Fed commentary.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Strong AAPL services beat, lifting tech sentiment.
- Eurozone inflation surprise drop, opening rate-cut path.
- Positive manufacturing data from China, easing global growth fears.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Market Data

CNBC — Earnings Calendar

Federal Reserve — Policy Statements

OPEC — Oil Prices